

BY FRANK MCGOWAN, News sports writer

A new visiting cast takes over the Rickwood stage tonight. It's the Nashville Vols coming in where the New Orleans Pelicans dropped three in a row, the last a 7-1 win yesterday afternoon, fashioned by the Barons' ace lefthander, John Gebhard.

The Belleville, Ill., stylist, now the Southern Association's leading pitcher with a 6-0 record, allowed Manager Andy Cohen's Pels three singles, all in different innings. Gebhard now has worked the last 18 innings on 13 hits and two earned runs and yesterday's game was his fifth complete game.

Manager Phil Page will shoot Righthander Wilson Parsons at the Vols in the curtain-raiser tonight as the Barons go about defending their loop lead. It stayed at a game and a half yesterday, with Memphis also winning.

The Vols are on the comeback road after losing nine in a row earlier and are featuring among others such familiar faces as Country Brown, Buddy Atkins, Bill Werber, one of the stars of the young season; Ken Landenberger and Bobby Durnbaugh.

GEBHARD WAS JUST TOO much for the Pels Sunday with Pel Skipper Cohen summing it up after the game, "The boy is a real good pitcher; he gets the ball over the plate with something on it and has plenty of pitching courage."

Lefthander Al Grunewald, an 18-8 winner in the Mexican League during the Winter and Summer last year, tried his pitching hand for the first time and didn't do too badly before giving way to another lefty—Joe Perrotta—in the eighth after Sam Suplizio had socked his second home run in two games.

Five of the Barons' eight hits were for extra bases, with Suplizio having a run-producing double in addition to his homer; Gerry MacKay contributing a three-run double, Milt Graff a triple and a single and Fritz Brickell a double. Gebhard also was a lot less than a weak sister at the plate with two singles and a base on balls as his contribution.

BARON BRIEFS—Hal Grote was sidelined with a bruised finger on his hand, having hurt the digit in batting practice Saturday night. He may be ready for action tonight. . . . Another Baron casualty, Catcher John Blanchard, was at the park, but didn't dress out. . . . Gebhard retired the Pels in order in eight of the nine innings with the visitors having but one man left on base. . . .

"We're not as bad as we have looked here," was Cohen's parting word, "and we are about ready to break loose against somebody." . . .

The batting slump of Left Fielder Earl Panko has hurt the Pels, the powerfully built Panko having hit nine home runs and driven in 28 runs before the slump hit him. . . . And don't fail to give a lot of the credit for the well-pitched games turned in by Jim O'Reilly and Gebhard to Danny Ryan who took over when Blanchard was laid low. Ryan is still an artist when he gets those "tools of ignorance" on and takes his place behind the bat. . . . Pressbox visitor saying his last thanks to sports writers was Johnny Dee, soon to be headed for his new basketball and business connection in Denver.

Baronmeter

Player	Ab	R	H	2b	3b	hr	rbi	Pct.
Jaculk	112	24	37	4	2	7	24	.330
Grote	92	15	30	5	0	3	18	.326
MacKay	112	27	36	4	3	5	15	.321
Parsons	15	4	4	1	0	0	4	.308
Gebhard	20	2	6	0	0	0	1	.300
Brickell	79	11	23	2	2	0	15	.291
Wehner	59	11	16	2	1	5	20	.271
Graff	115	20	31	2	2	1	13	.270
Suplizio	57	7	15	2	0	2	6	.263
Wingo	21	2	5	0	0	0	2	.238
Blanchard	94	17	21	8	1	2	16	.223
Melsner	67	14	14	3	2	3	10	.209
Frigge	62	8	12	0	2	0	7	.194
Gabler	6	0	1	0	0	0	1	.167
O'Reilly	16	1	2	0	1	0	1	.125
Ryan	15	1	0	0	0	0	0	.000
Utley	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	.000
Merriitt	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	.000